Cedar Valley Family Center AI use policy

Draft for board review · Effective when the board approves it · Owner: Luis, operations manager · Next review: in 12 months

Why we have this policy. We want AI to take drafting and paperwork off your plate. We want to protect families, students and donors, and stop errors going out under our name.

Who it covers. All staff, volunteers, contractors and board members.

TOOLS WE USE

- **Microsoft Copilot:** Pilot group (development team and Luis): donor names and gift amounts OK. No case files or student records.
- **ChatGPT:** Work email only, for work with nothing about a real person in it.
- **New tools, add-ons and AI features.** Luis approves any new tool, plugin or AI feature in software we already use, like Bloomerang. He checks where data goes. Grace, our compliance director, also reviews anything touching client data.
- **Accounts.** Use your work email and turn off any setting that trains the vendor on what you type.

WHAT YOU CAN USE AI FOR

- **Everyone, now.** Everyone may use ChatGPT, with a work email, for work with nothing about a real person in it. Copilot is for pilot license holders only.
- Reword an email, brainstorm or explain a form.
- Teachers: make lesson plans, reading passages and practice questions, and translate handouts into Spanish. No student names or scores.
- Pilot group, in Copilot: draft appeals and thank-you letters with donor names, and summarize grant guidelines.

NEEDS APPROVAL FIRST

- Grant or county reports with AI help — *Your manager*
- Client data in a tool approved for it — *Luis and Grace*

OFF LIMITS

- **Never put this into an AI tool** unless the tool is approved for it above: Case files: names, addresses, income, immigration status, domestic violence history, mental health and substance use notes (county contract). Student names, grades, scores, attendance (district agreement). Donor giving history and gift notes. Staff and HR files. Passwords and logins.
- Using AI to decide emergency fund awards or class placement, or to score intake essays.
- Passing off an AI-generated photo as a real family.
- Browser plugins that read your email.
- AI writing public statements. A person writes them.

CHECK EVERYTHING BEFORE IT GOES OUT

- You are responsible for what you send. Check facts, names, numbers and tone. Check every number in county or funder reports against our records.

DECISIONS ABOUT PEOPLE

- People decide who gets services, money, a job or a program place. AI may help prepare, never decide.

BEING OPEN ABOUT AI

- A thank-you letter needs no AI note if a person signed it and meant it. Label AI-generated materials. Tell funders honestly how we use AI.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Tell Luis and Grace the same day. Grace decides if client data was breached under the county contract. Reporting a mistake is expected, not punished.

WHO OWNS THIS POLICY

- Luis keeps this policy current and runs an hour of training for everyone. The board approves changes.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BOARD

- Should we buy ChatGPT Team or extend Copilot to everyone?
- What does the county allow for AI help with case notes?
- Should Communications use Canva's AI image features, and under what rules?
- How should we address staff worry that AI is a step toward cutting positions?

Sample policy for an invented organization, drafted by Fulton Ring from a mock 30-minute call. Not legal advice; not reviewed by a real nonprofit.